

3.4 DVD

Perhaps the most common form of digital video today is DVD video. A lot of us have DVD players at home, or DVD-ROM or DVD-RW drives that we use to watch DVD movies with. All home theatre systems are based on DVD video quality, and newer technologies such as High Definition Television (HDTV) will allow us to watch movies in even better quality.



The DVD is as good as it gets for personal entertainment currently, and it's necessary that we understand what all that jargon means when talking about DVDs.

Given below is a jargon buster that will demystify a lot of terms and specifications that you will come across, and also help you understand how DVD video works.

DVD: Digital Video Disk / Digital Versatile Disk. This is a media format that can hold between 4.7 GB and 17 GB of data. Physically, it is the same size as a Compact Disc (CD)

DVD-ROM: The first DVD format, or a DVD drive that can read, but cannot write to a DVD disc

DVD-5: Single-layered, single-sided DVDs with a capacity of just under 5 GB (4.7 GB approximately)

DVD-9: Dual-Layered, single-sided DVDs with a capacity of 8.5 GB

DVD-10: Double-sided, single-layered DVDs with a capacity of 9.4 GB